

Why do students leave community college without finishing their programs?

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Agenda

- Community Colleges' Role and Mission
- Who are community college students
- Why students choose to attend a community college
- Reasons for leaving community college without an academic degree
- Q&A

Community Colleges' Role and Mission

- Community colleges provide educational options for students seeking entry-level career training. The education program may culminate in an applied technology associate degree, certificate, diploma or transfer program.

Community College Offering

- Certificate Program
- Associate Degree Program
- Transfer to 4-year institution

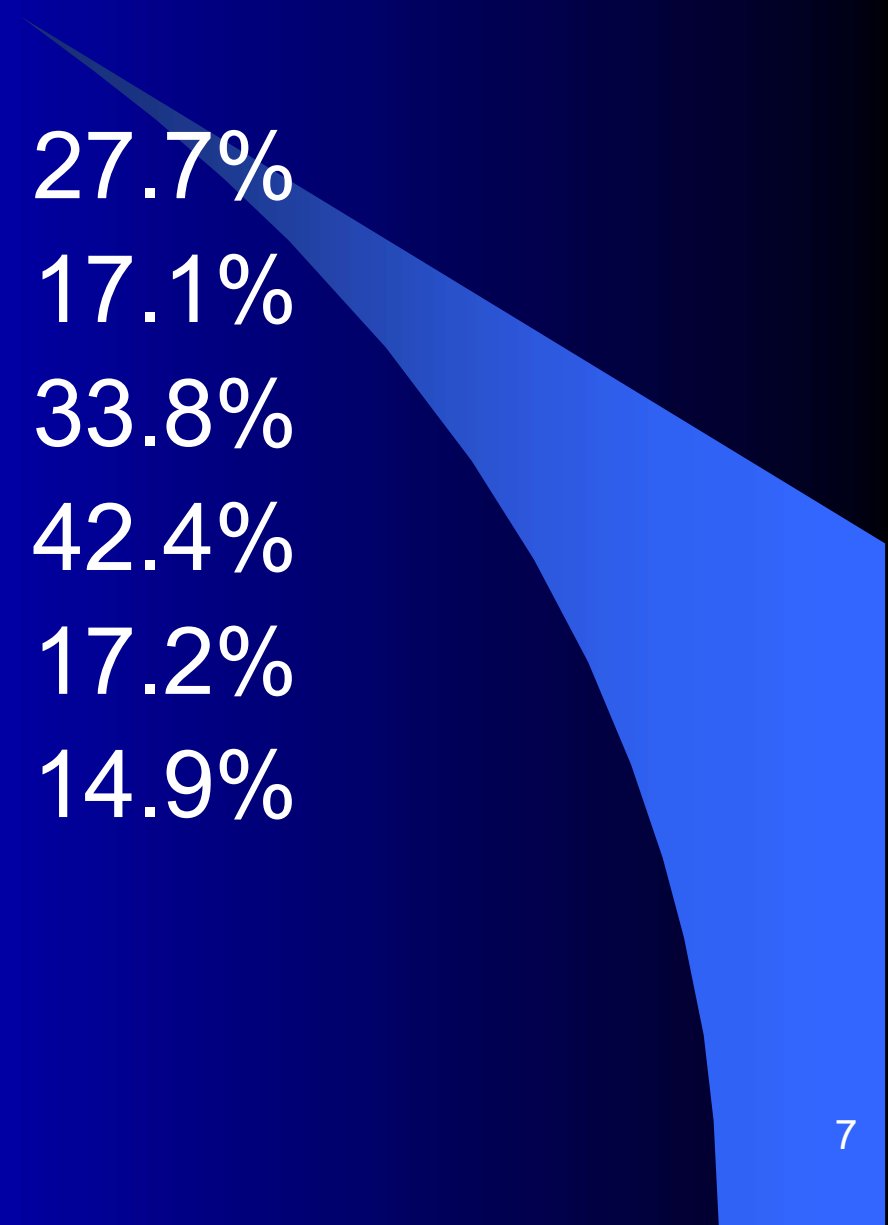
Time to Degree

- Full-time study (2 years)
- Full-time study for certificate programs (1 year)
- Part-time study for certificate programs (2 ½ years)
- Part-time study for associate's degree (3 ½ years)

Who are community college students

- High school students (K-12)
- Traditional college students (age 18-25 yrs)
- Adult Learner students (age > 25 yrs)
- Financial hardship students
- Low-income and disadvantage students

Sociographic Characteristics



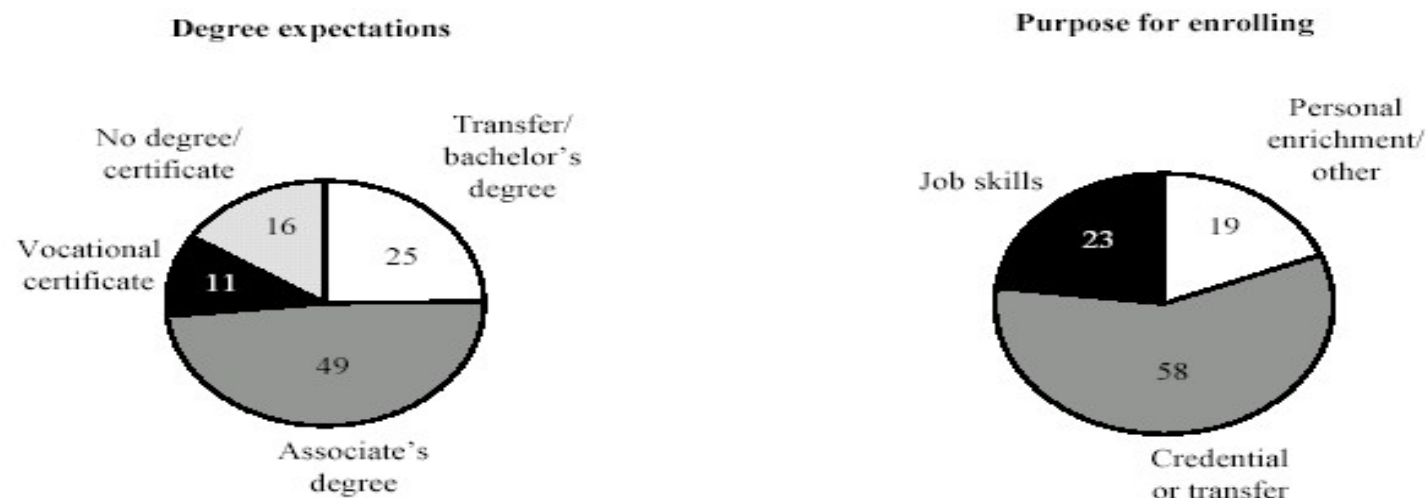
● Age: 25+ yrs	27.7%
● Employed full-time	17.1%
● Don't work	33.8%
● Live with parents	42.4%
● Live with spouse	17.2%
● Live on campus	14.9%

Why students choose to to attend a community college

- Open-access
- Financial hardship
- Poor academic performance in high school
- Limited English-language skills or other basic skill deficiencies
- Lower tuition fees
- Transfer to a 4-year institution for baccalaureate degree.
- Enrichment opportunities
- Improve job skills
- Seeking additional job skills
- Train for a new career
- Technical certification
- Want to enter the workforce quickly

Enrollment Statistics (1)

Figure 2. Percentage distribution of 1995–96 beginning postsecondary students first enrolled in public 2-year institutions according to their specific degree expectations and reported primary purpose for enrolling

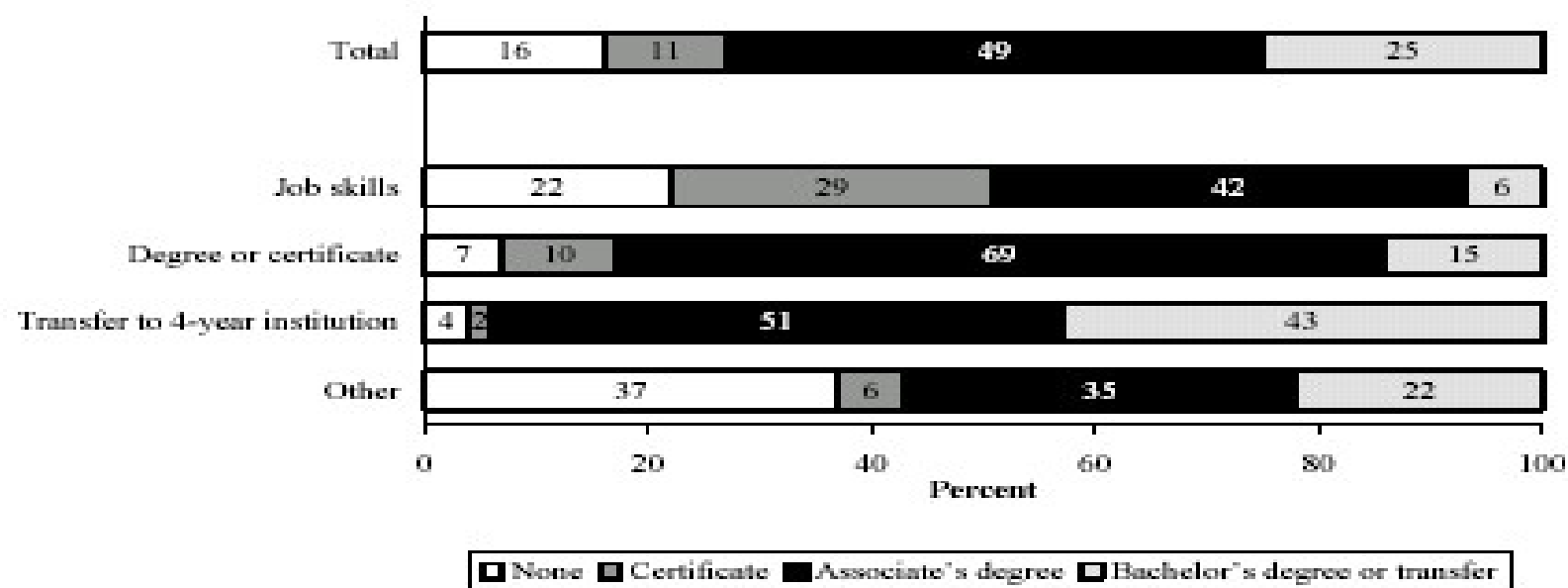


NOTE: Detail may not sum to totals because of rounding.

SOURCE: U.S. Department of Education, National Center for Education Statistics, 1996/01 Beginning Postsecondary Students Longitudinal Study (BPS:96/01).

Enrollment Statistics (2)

Figure 3. Percentage distribution of 1995–96 beginning postsecondary students first enrolled in public 2-year institutions according to their degree expectations from that college and purpose for enrolling

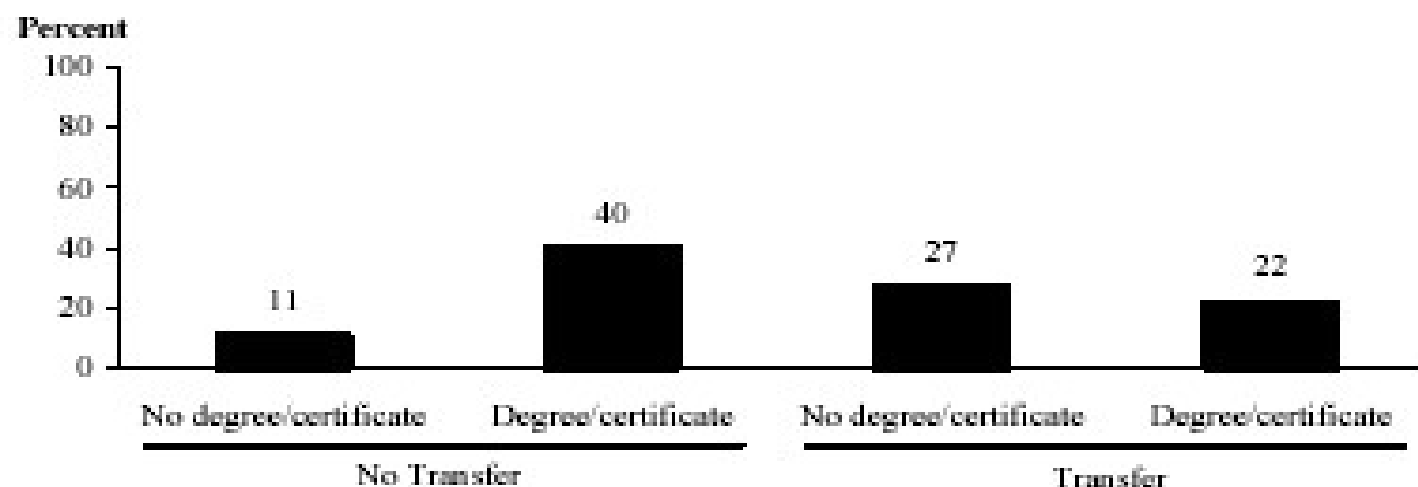


NOTE: Detail may not sum to totals because of rounding.

SOURCE: U.S. Department of Education, National Center for Education Statistics, 1996/01 Beginning Postsecondary Students Longitudinal Study (BPS:96/01).

Degree/Certificate and Transfer Statistics

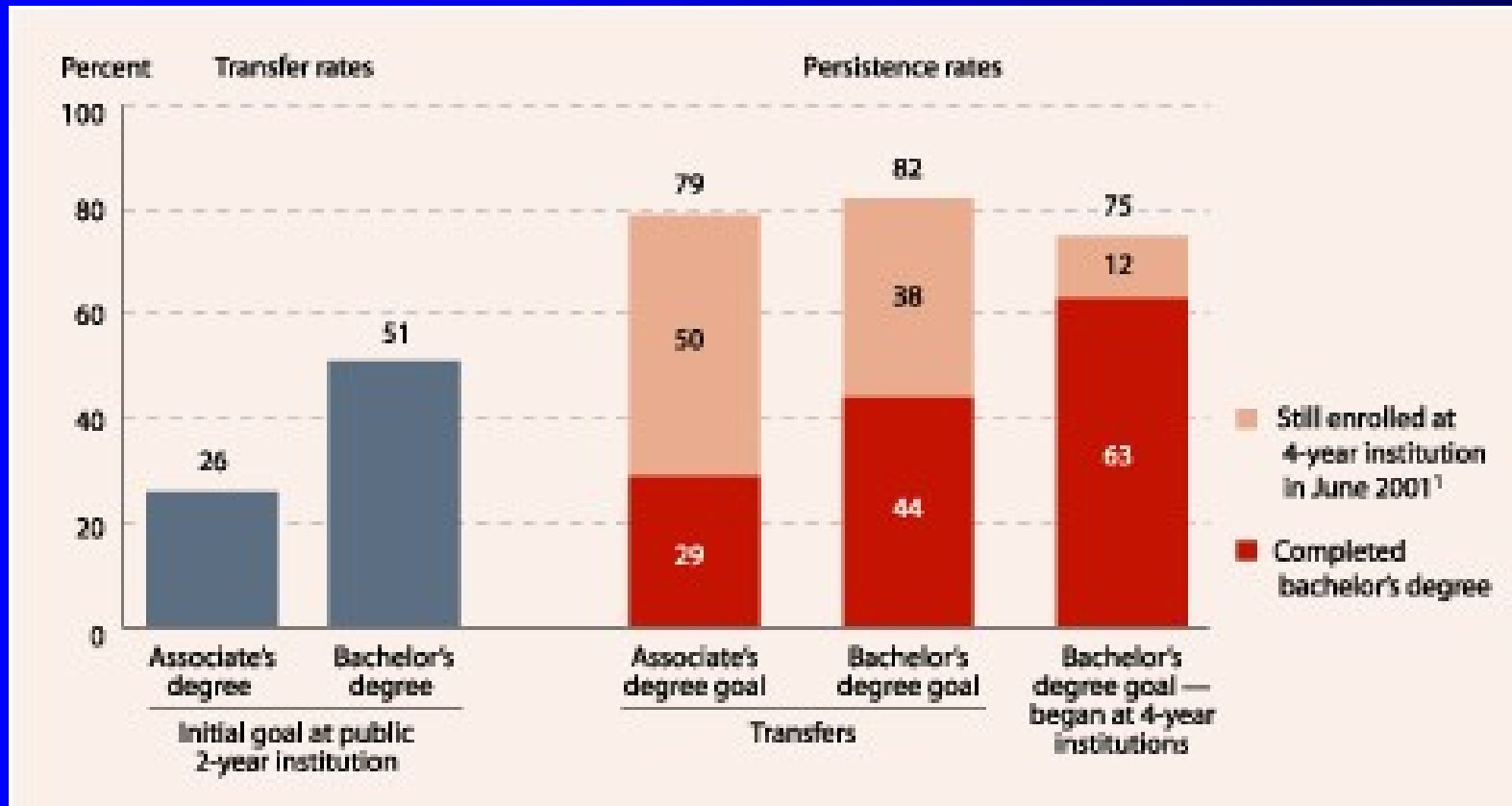
Figure 4. Percentage distribution of 1995–96 beginning postsecondary students first enrolled in public 2-year institutions according to their degree/certificate and transfer expectations



NOTE: Detail may not sum to totals because of rounding.

SOURCE: U.S. Department of Education, National Center for Education Statistics, 1996/01 Beginning Postsecondary Students Longitudinal Study (BPS:96/01).

Transfer to 4-year Institution Statistics



Enrolled at a 4-year institution without a bachelor's degree in June 2001.

SOURCE: U.S. Department of Education, NCES, 1996/01 Beginning Postsecondary Students Longitudinal Study (BPS:96/01).

Why do students leave a community college without completing their academic program

- Transferred to 4-year institution
- Completed a specific course or two, to upgrade job skills
- Completed a few course to satisfy personal enrichment objectives
- Exploring whether they want to pursue postsecondary education.
- Family responsibility
- Significant time commitment required to complete a credential program
- Financial hardship
- Poor academic preparation (drop-out)

Community College Completion Outcomes

- Attained Certificate
- Attained Associated Degree
- Transferred to 4-year institution

Community College Completion Employment Outcomes

Table 12. Percentage of 1992 high school graduates first enrolled in public 2-year institutions by December 1994 according to whether postsecondary education led to various employment improvements, by attainment as of 2000

Attainment as of 2000	Postsecondary education led to:				
	Higher salary	Better jobs	More responsibility	Promotion opportunities	Improved job performance
Total	60.8	66.4	69.0	62.1	64.1
Community college student attainment					
Attained any degree or certificate	79.7	84.3	84.8	78.9	78.3
Attained certificate or license	72.9	78.2	78.9	67.7	70.5
Attained associate's degree	75.5	79.3	79.5	72.6	76.4
Attained bachelor's degree or higher	87.5	92.3	93.0	91.2	84.8
No degree or certificate attained					
Ever attended 4-year institution	65.3	68.8	73.6	67.8	67.9
Never attended 4-year institution, enrolled 2000	37.5	53.2	57.3	41.3	53.6
Never attended 4-year institution, not enrolled	35.3	41.5	45.4	39.0	42.9

SOURCE: U.S. Department of Education, National Center for Education Statistics, National Education Longitudinal Study of 1988 (NELS:88/2000), "Fourth Follow-up, 2000, Data Analysis System."

Summary and Conclusion

- Community colleges are open-access institutions focused on quality teaching and public service. They offer counseling and support to help a diverse range of students succeed, particularly those who have been underserved.
- Many students choose community colleges for job training rather than just earning a degree.
- About one-fourth of the students who attend a community college said to transfer to a 4-year institution for a bachelor's degree.
- The reasons for not completing are complex, including poor academic preparation, significant time commitment required to complete a credential, as well as other factors such as family responsibilities and financial hardship.
- Many students who leave community colleges without completing a credential do so to upgrade job skills, pursue personal enrichment, and enter the labor market.

Where to Get More Information

- http://nces.ed.gov/programs/coe/2003/pdf/19_2003.pdf
- <http://nces.ed.gov/pubs2001/2001163.pdf>
- <http://nces.ed.gov/pubs2003/2003164.pdf>
- <http://search.nces.ed.gov/query.html?col=nces&qt=transfer+student&charset=iso-8859-1>
- [http:// www.edc.org/hec/pubs/communitycolleges.html](http://www.edc.org/hec/pubs/communitycolleges.html)
- [http:// www.bccat.bc.ca/pubs/today.pdf](http://www.bccat.bc.ca/pubs/today.pdf)
- [http:// www.archon.educ.kent.edu/~nebraska/research/profile5.html](http://www.archon.educ.kent.edu/~nebraska/research/profile5.html)
- [http:// www.ccpe.state.ne.us/PublicDoc/CCPE/CompPlan/CCRM.asp](http://www.ccpe.state.ne.us/PublicDoc/CCPE/CompPlan/CCRM.asp)
- [http:// www.teenagerstoday.com/resources/articles/ccvuniv.htm](http://www.teenagerstoday.com/resources/articles/ccvuniv.htm)
- <http://www.paccd.cc.ca.us/instadmn/socsci/jleekim/credit.htm>